FREE GUIDE

BUILD YOUR BUSINESS WEBSITE IN CANVA.

Every click, step by step.
From picking a template to your own domain.

no design experience needed



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BEFORE YOU START.

Gather these first and the building goes fast. You can build and publish on a free Canva account. A custom domain needs a paid plan (Step 9).

- [ ] **A Canva account.** Sign up free at canva.com.
- [ ] **Your logo,** as a PNG. A transparent background looks best.
- [ ] **5–10 photos:** your work, your space, your team, your products.
- [ ] **Your words:** what you do, who it's for, services and prices, hours, address, phone, email.
- [ ] **Your colors and fonts,** if you have them.
- [ ] **An afternoon.** Most people finish in 2–3 hours.

HOW THIS GUIDE WORKS

Every step has the exact buttons to click, a real Canva screenshot with numbered spots, and a tip.

Buttons look like this.

write your text in your phone's notes first. it's the slowest part!

STEP 1

PLAN YOUR PAGES.

Decide what people need to know, and what you want them to do next: call, book, or visit. Most small businesses need these four.

HOME

Your name, what you do in one line, one great photo, and one main button (Call, Book, or Visit).

ABOUT

Who you are, why you started, and what makes you different. A photo of you builds trust.

SERVICES

What you offer, with prices or “starting at” prices. Short lists beat long paragraphs.

CONTACT

Phone, email, address, hours, and a map or directions. Make it easy to reach you in one tap.

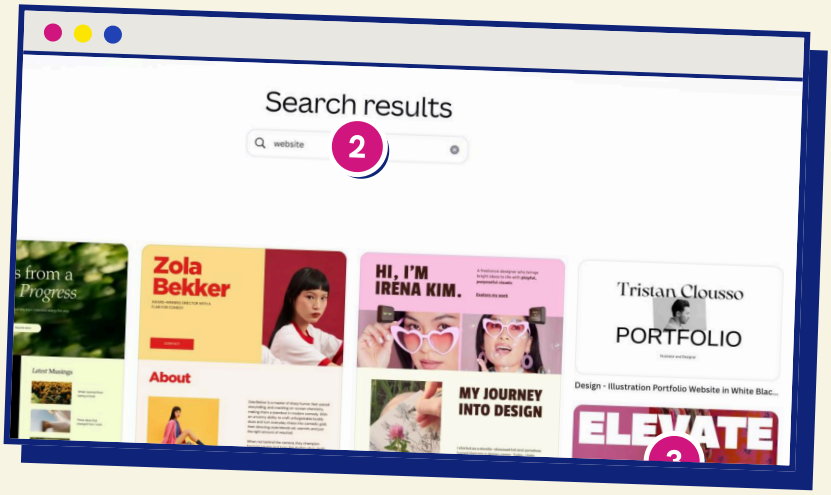
TIP

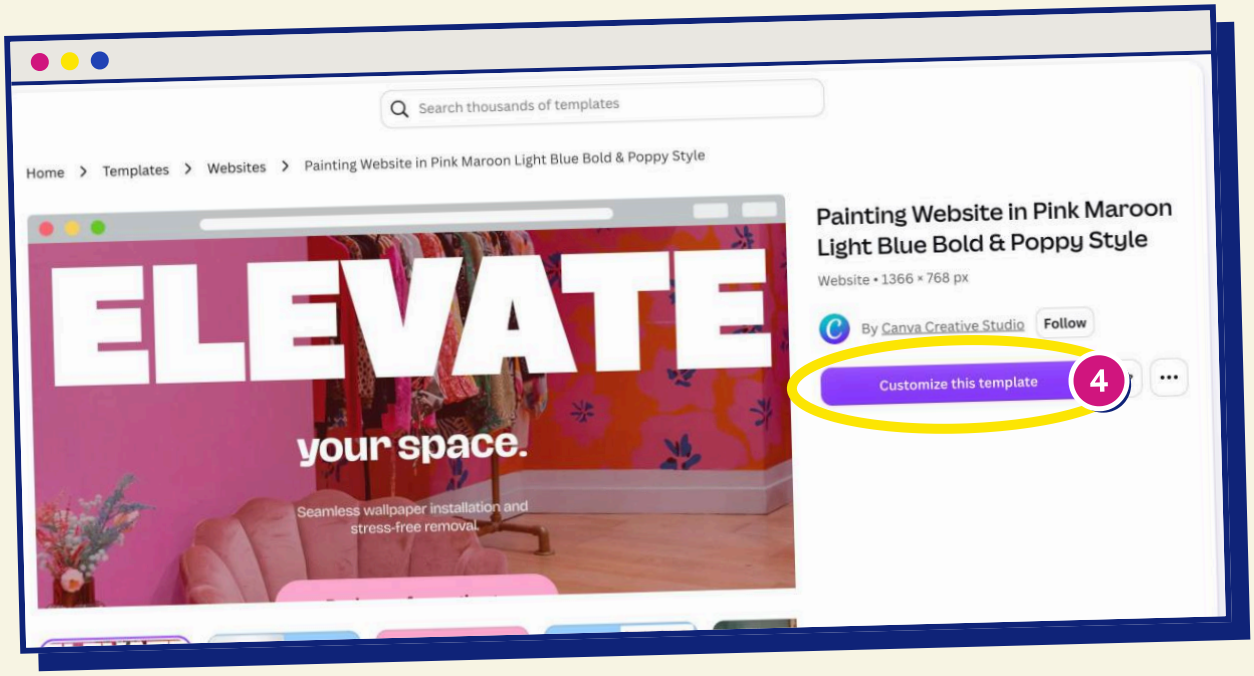
Give every page **one job**. If a page tries to do three things, split it in two. A short page title like **Services** works best, because it becomes your menu label in Step 4.

STEP 2

PICK A TEMPLATE.

1. Go to **canva.com** and sign in.
2. In the search bar, type **website** and press Enter.
3. Scroll the results and click a template to open it.
4. Click **Customize this template**. Canva opens your own copy in the editor.



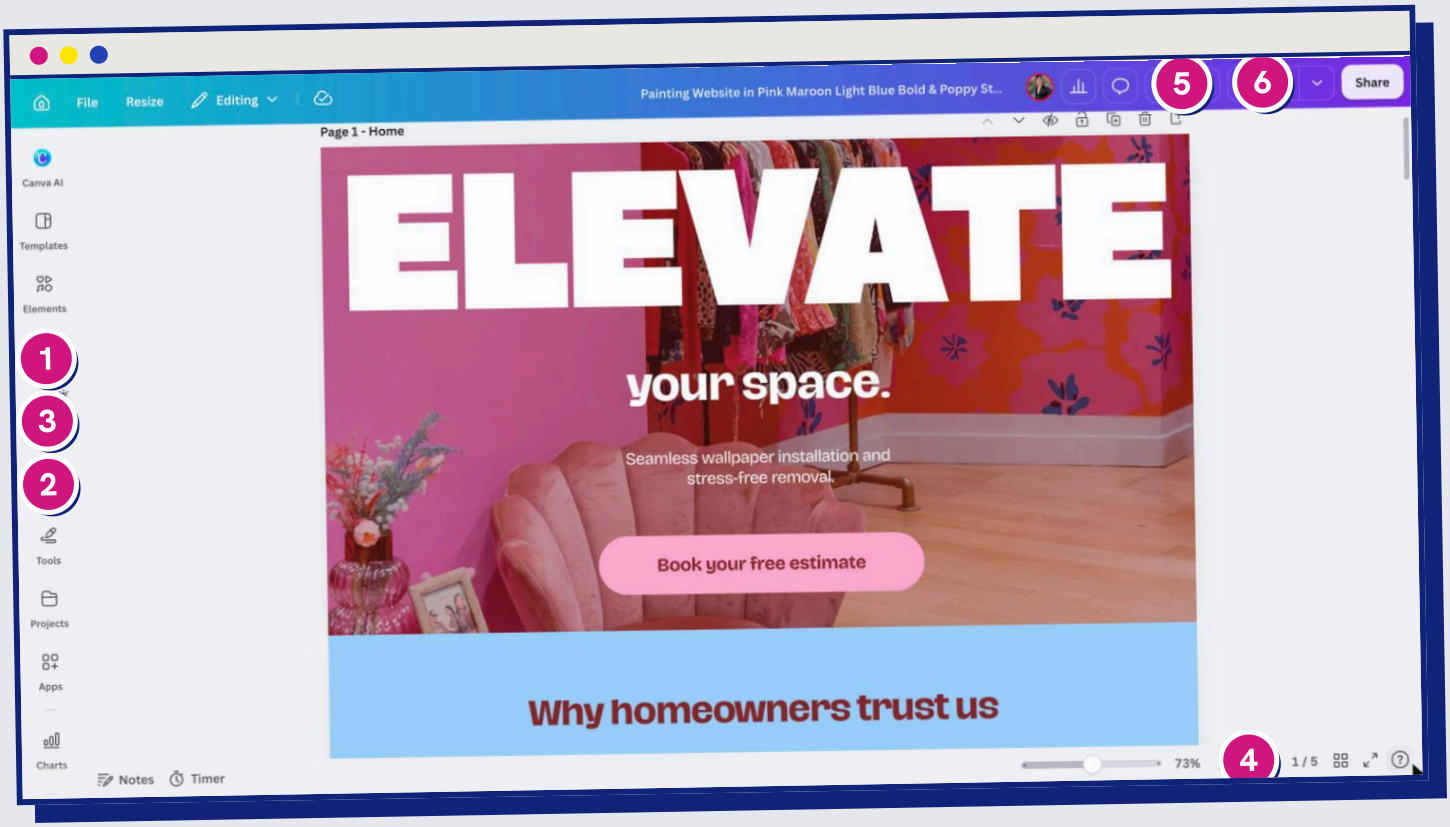


TIP

Choose by **layout**, not color. Every color, photo and word can change. Look for a template that already has the pages you planned.

STEP 3

GET TO KNOW THE EDITOR.

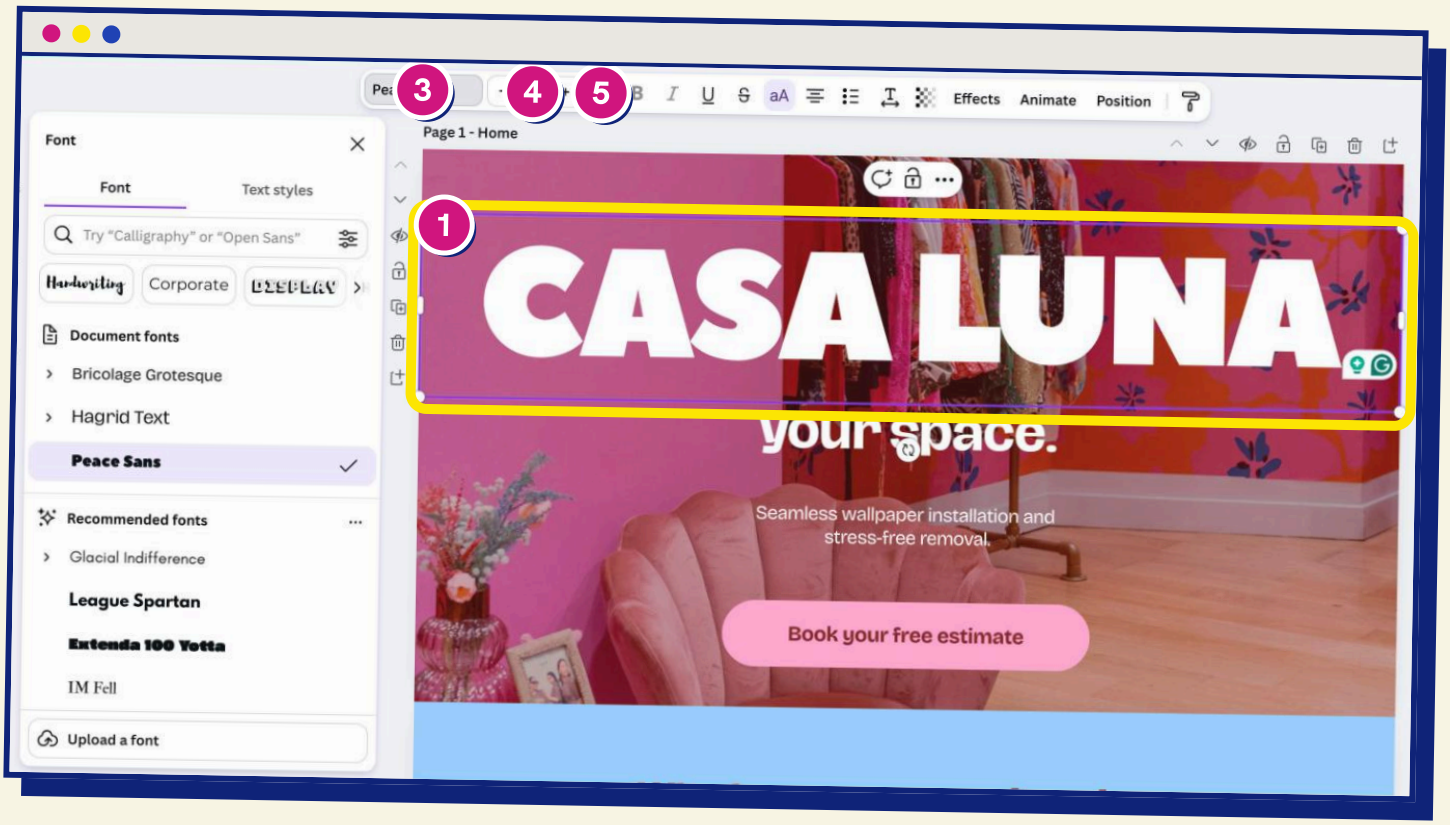


1. **Text** adds new headings and paragraphs.
2. **Uploads** is where your logo and photos go.
3. **Brand** keeps your colors, fonts and logo in one place.
4. **Pages** shows every page of your site at once.
5. **Preview** shows your site like a visitor will see it.
6. **Publish** puts it online. Leave this for Step 8.

made a mistake? cmd+Z (Mac) or ctrl+Z undoes it.

STEP 3 · WORDS

MAKE IT YOURS: WORDS & FONTS.



1. Click a text box once to select it, then **double-click** to type.
2. Swap the template's sample words for your own, page by page.
3. Click the **font name** in the top bar to open the font list. Pick one and it changes right away.
4. Use the **size box** (or – and +) to make text bigger or smaller.
5. Click the **A** with the color bar to change the text color.

TIP

Stick to **two fonts**: one for headings, one for everything else. Keep paragraphs at size **16 or bigger**. Uploading your own font needs a paid plan; free accounts use Canva's fonts.

STEP 3 · LOOK

PHOTOS, LOGO & COLORS.

PHOTOS

1. Click **Uploads** → **Upload files** and pick your photos.
2. Drag one of your photos **on top of** a template photo. It swaps in and keeps the same frame.
3. Double-click a photo to move or zoom it inside its frame.

LOGO

1. Upload your logo PNG the same way.
2. Drag it to the top corner of your Home page, where people expect it.
3. Delete the template's sample logo: select it and press **Delete**.

COLORS

1. Click a shape or background.
2. Click the **color square** in the top bar.
3. Pick a color, or type your color's hex code (like #2042B4) in the search box.

CLEAN UP

Delete anything you don't need: select it and press **Delete**. Empty space looks better than filler.

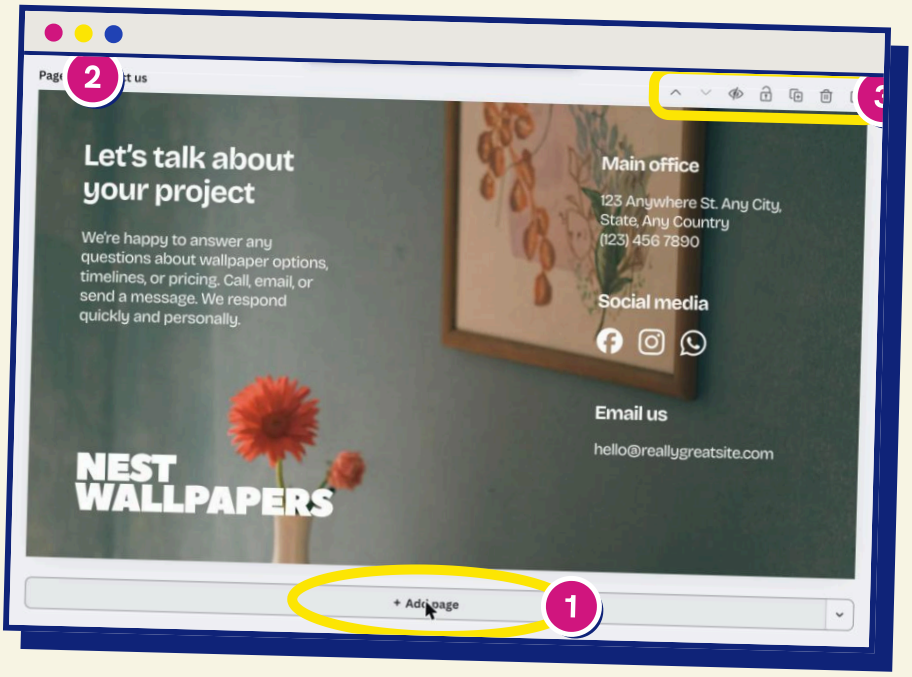
TIP

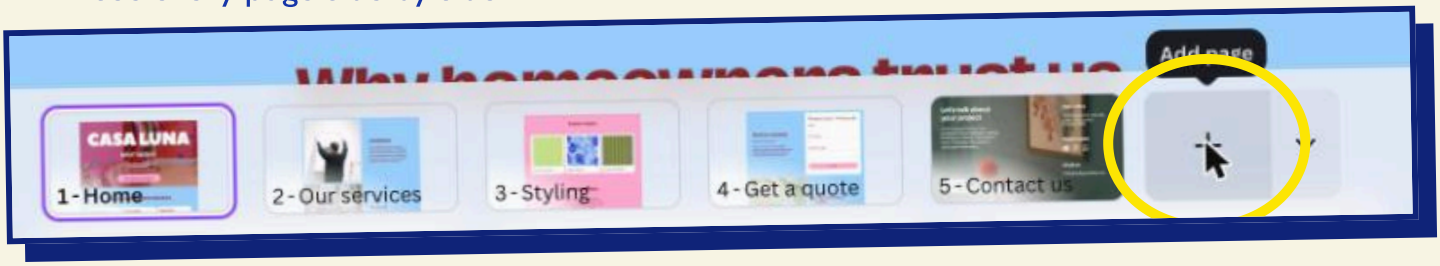
Use **real photos** of your work and your place, even phone photos. Customers trust them more than stock pictures. Take them in daylight, near a window.

STEP 4

BUILD YOUR PAGES.

1. To add a page, click **+ Add page** under your last page.
2. Hover over the top of each page and type a short **page title**, like **Services**. Your menu is made from these titles.
3. Use the small **icons above a page** to move it up or down, duplicate it, hide it, or delete it.
4. Click **Pages** at the bottom to see every page side by side.





TIP

Each page gets its own address, like **yoursite.com/about**. Need a page that looks like one you already made? **Duplicate** it and change the words.

STEP 5

MAKE YOUR BUTTONS WORK.

A button only works once it has a link. Do this for every button and every “Call us” or “Email us” text.

1. Click the button or text to select it.
2. Click the **link icon** in the top bar (or right-click → **Link**).
3. Open **Pages in this document** and pick a page, or paste a link from the box on the right. Click **Done**
4. Test every link later in Preview.

TIP

Put your **main button** (Call, Book, or Visit) at the top of Home, and again at the bottom of every page.

WHAT TO TYPE

A website:
`https://yourlink.com`

Email:
`mailto:you@yourbiz.com`

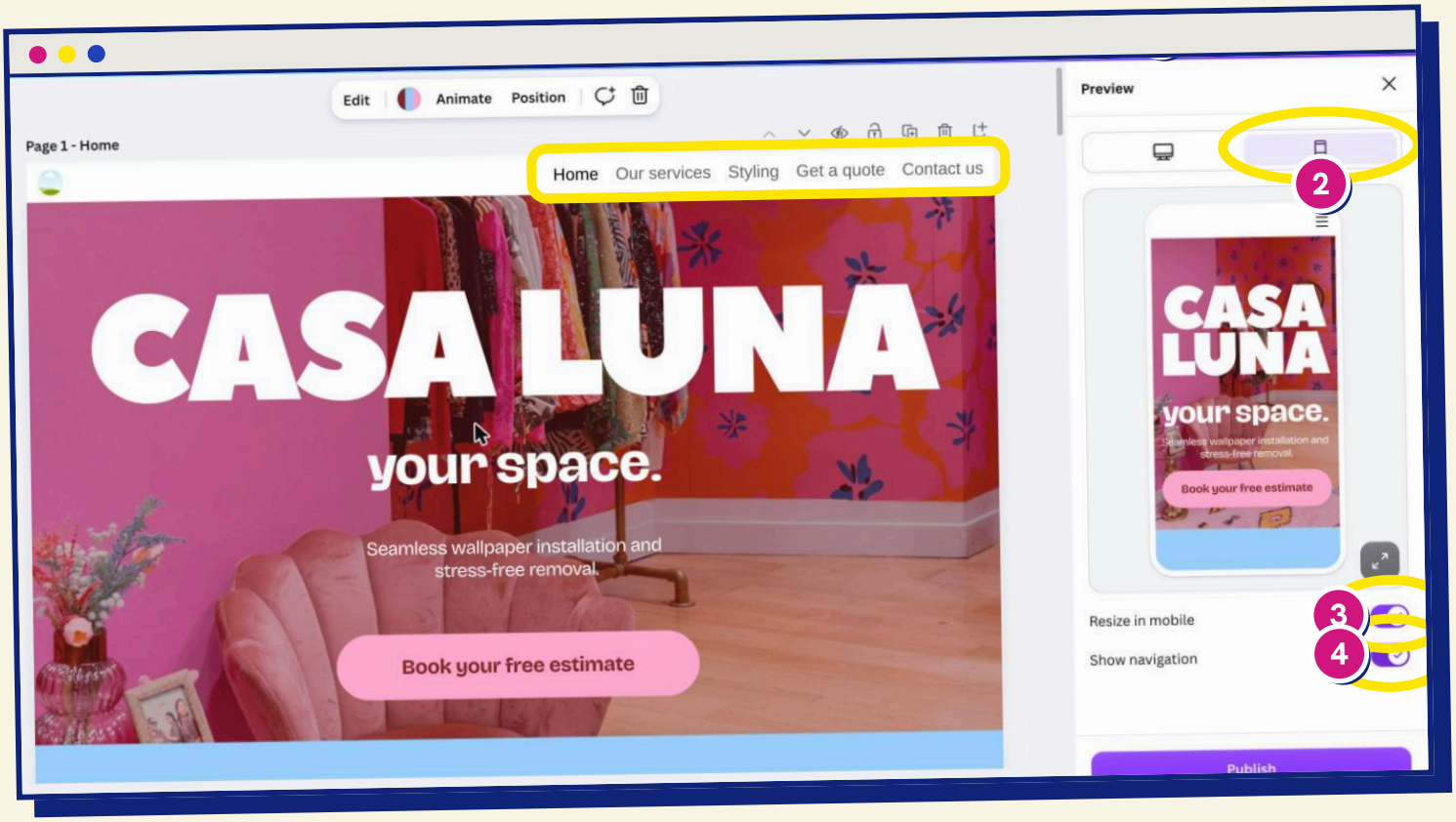
Phone (tap to call):
`tel:+19565551234`

Directions:
paste your Google Maps share link

Test email and phone links on your own phone after you publish.

STEP 6

TURN ON YOUR MENU.



1. Click **Preview** in the top bar.
2. Switch between the **computer** and **phone** icons to see both.
3. Turn on **Resize in mobile** so your site fits phones.
4. Turn on **Show navigation**. Your page titles appear as a menu at the top. (It's also in Publish → Settings.)

TIP

Most of your visitors will be on a phone. In phone view, check that the text isn't tiny, buttons are easy to tap, and nothing overlaps. Fix it in the editor, then preview again.

STEP 7

TAKE IT FOR A TEST RUN.

Open **Preview** and go through this list on both computer and phone view.

- [x] Every menu link goes to the right page.
- [x] Every button works: call, email, book, directions.
- [x] Your phone number, address and email are spelled right.
- [x] Prices and hours are current.
- [x] Photos look sharp and nothing is cut off on the phone.
- [x] Someone can find how to contact you in one scroll.
- [x] Your logo shows up at the top of Home.

WATCH OUT

Templates hide **sample text** in small places. Search every page for things like **“123 Anywhere St.”**, **“(123) 456 7890”**, **“reallygreatsite.com”** and **“Lorem ipsum”**.

ask a friend to try it on their phone too!

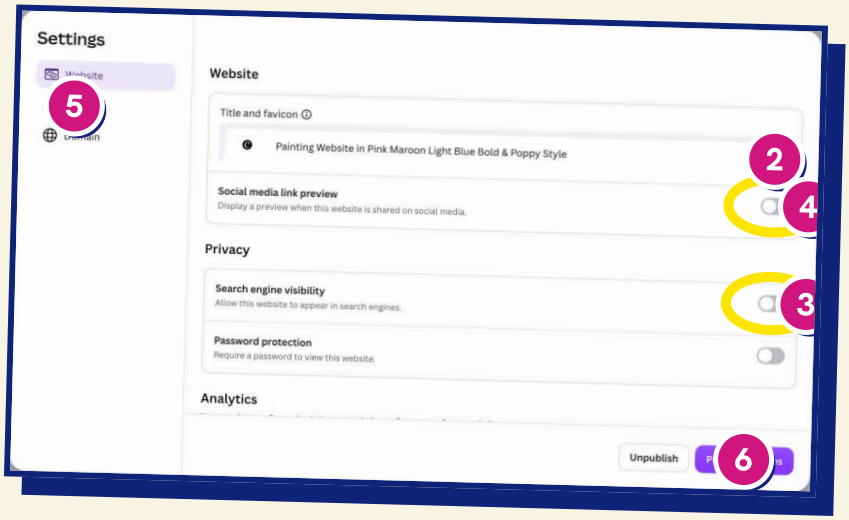
STEP 8

PUBLISH & SETTINGS.

HEADS UP

Clicking **Publish** can put your site live **right away** on a free Canva address (like **yourname.my.canva.site**). Finish Step 7 first.





1. After publishing, click **Edit URL** to change the free address to your business name.
2. Click **Settings**. Under **Title and favicon**, set the name shown on the browser tab.
3. Check that **Search engine visibility** is on so Google can find you. It was off in our test.
4. Turn on **Social media link preview** so your link looks good when shared.
5. In the **SEO** tab (called **Pages** in newer versions), write one sentence about your business and your city.
6. Click **Publish changes**. Do this after **every** edit, or visitors won't see it.

STEP 9

GET YOUR OWN DOMAIN.

A domain like **yourbusiness.com** looks more professional than the free address, and it's easier to say out loud and print on your cards. On the free plan, your site also shows a small “Designed with Canva” footer.

1. Open the **Publish** menu and click **Get a custom domain** (it's also in **Settings → Domain**).
2. Buy a new domain there (on a computer), or connect one you already own. Connecting your own needs a paid Canva plan, and domains renew every year.
3. Follow Canva's steps, then click **Publish changes**. A new domain can take a little while to start working.

PICK A GOOD ONE

- ✓ Short and easy to spell
- ✓ Matches your business name
- ✓ .com if you can get it
- ✓ Easy to say over the phone
- ✗ No hyphens or numbers



this is the part where most people get stuck. that's where I come in →

STUCK?
I CAN HELP.

Your domain, your layout, or that one thing you can't get working. I can finish it with you, or build the whole site for you.

send "WEBSITE" to Rivers

hellorivers.com
¡Se habla español!



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